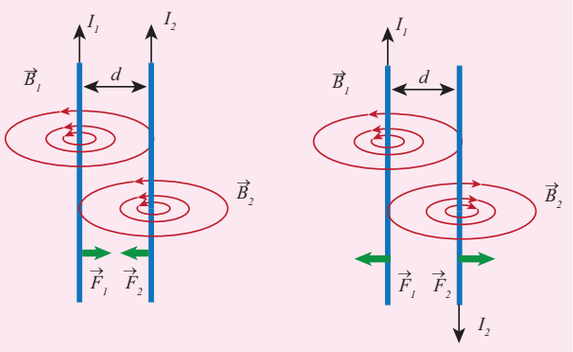


Figure 5.10 Attractive and repulsive force on current carrying wires

Using Fleming's left hand rule we can find that the direction of the force on each wire would be towards each other when the current in both of them are flowing in the same direction, i.e., the wires would experience an attractive force. However, if the direction of the flow of current is in opposite direction, then the force on each of the wire will be in opposite direction. These are shown in Figure 5.10 and the perpendicular view of the same is shown in Figure 5.11.

Connection between Electricity and Magnetism:

Before 18th century people thought that magnetism and electricity were separate subjects of study. After Oersted's experiment the electricity and magnetism were united and became a single subject called 'Electromagnetism'.

When there is current, the magnetic field is produced and the current carrying conductor behaves like a magnet. You may now wonder how was it possible for a lodestone to behave like a magnet when there was no current passing through it. Only in the twentieth century, we understood that the magnetic property arises due to the motion of electrons in the lodestone. In the circuit the electrons flow from negative of the battery to positive of the battery and constitutes current. As a result it produces magnetic field. In natural magnets and artificial magnets that we buy in shops, the electrons move around the nucleus constitutes

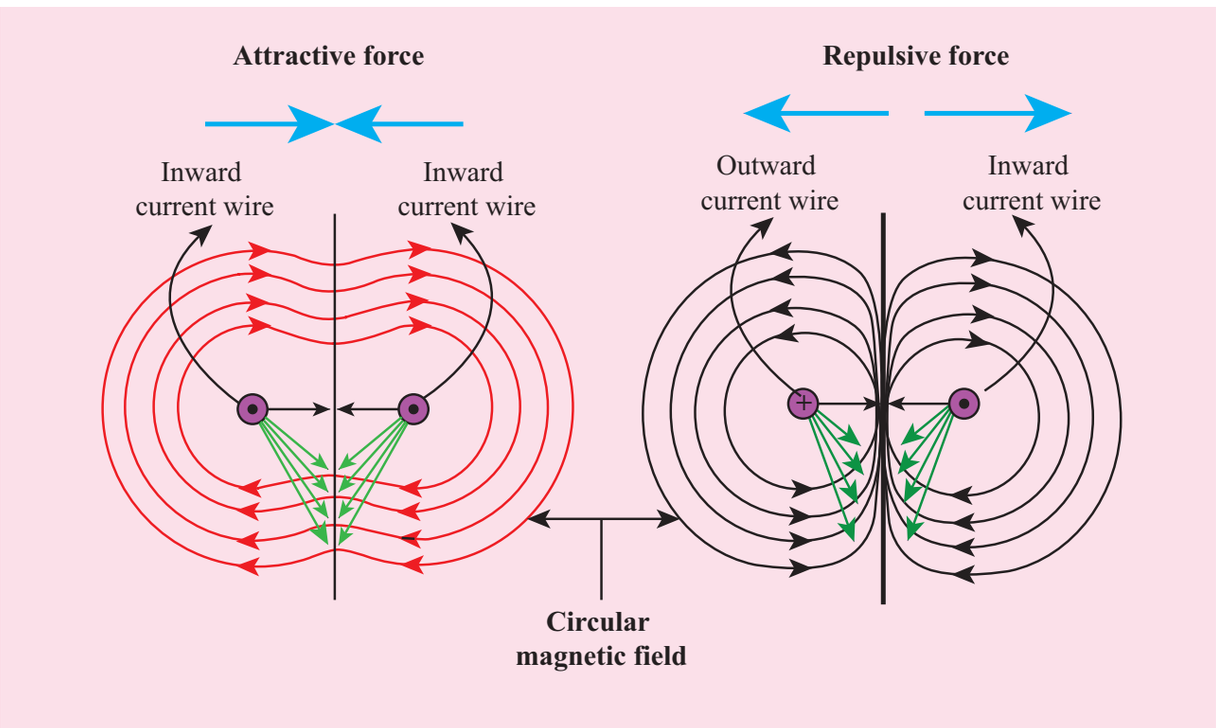


Figure 5.11 Force on current carrying conductors when viewed perpendicular to the direction of current

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